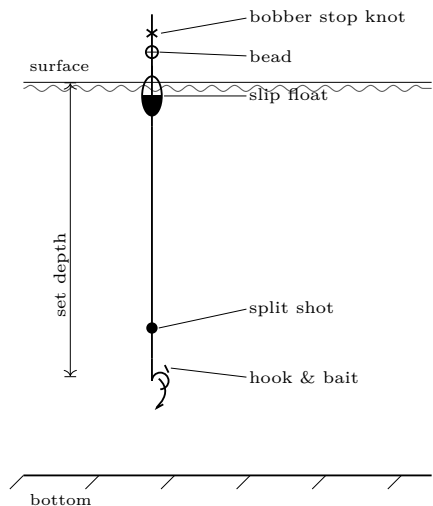


Slip Bobber

Hold a live bait at an exact depth, in any depth of water



What it does	The float slides freely on the line until it hits the stop knot. You can fish 20 ft down and still reel the float to the rod tip to cast.
Why it matters	A fixed bobber can only fish as deep as your rod is long. A slip float has no such limit, which is the whole reason it exists.
Components	Bobber stop (thread or rubber), small bead, slip float, one or two split shot, hook.
Hook	Size 8–10 for panfish, 4–6 for crappie on a minnow, 1/0 for bass or walleye on a leech.
Line	4 lb for panfish; 6–8 lb for bass and walleye.
Catches	Bluegill, pumpkinseed, crappie, perch, largemouth, walleye, pike.

Build it

1. Thread the **bobber stop** onto the main line and slide it up. Tighten it enough to hold but loose enough to slide when you pull — this is what you will adjust all day.
2. Thread the **bead**. Its only job is to stop the small stop knot from pulling through the float’s hole.
3. Thread the **float**, top end first.
4. Pinch on **split shot** 8–12 in above where the hook will be. Enough weight that the float sits upright with only its tip showing — an over-floated bobber cannot signal a bite.
5. Tie on the **hook** with an improved clinch knot, *see the **knots** sheet*.

Fish it

Set the depth	Bait should ride just above whatever the fish are holding on — the weed tops, the bottom, the school. Fish look up far more readily than down. Start a foot above and work down.
Cast	The float sits at the split shot for the cast, then the weight pulls line through the float until the stop knot arrives. Give it a few seconds to settle before you judge anything.
Read it	A bluegill takes the float sideways and down in small taps. A crappie lifts it and lays it flat — that is a fish swimming up with the bait, and it is a bite. Walleye pull it under slowly and steadily.
Set the hook	Reel the slack, then sweep. Do not snap a rod at a crappie, <i>see the Black Crappie sheet</i> .
Adjust	If the float lies flat and stays flat you are too deep and the bait is on the bottom. Slide the stop down.

When to use it
Any time you know the depth and want the bait to stay there: over a weed edge, over a crappie school suspended at 14 ft, over a bluegill bed, or with a big sucker over a weed flat for pike. It is the most controllable live-bait presentation there is, and it is the easiest rig in this guide to hand to a beginner.

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